How Well Does the Family Know Mom's Week?

Twelve quick questions about what the family knows. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete the family's picture is. It doesn't measure Mom, and no answer here means she needs more help or less.

1. Has Mom described an ordinary week to someone in the family, in her own words?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Could you describe an ordinary day for her: morning, daytime, evening and overnight?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Is it written down where Mom lives and who is around her day to day?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Have you listed everyone who helps her, including the small things like a drive to an appointment or bringing in the mail?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. For each person on that list, do you know what they actually do and how often?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Have the relatives compared how each of them would describe her week?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you know what has changed in her routine recently, and roughly when?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you written down what nobody in the family knows yet, instead of filling it in?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Is there one written picture of how things work today, in place of several people's memories?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Does everyone in the family know where that page is kept?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Has the family agreed when to look at it again: a date, or the kind of change that would make it worth updating?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Do you know what the next conversation is, and who will start it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what the family knows, not how Mom is doing. A short “What you know” list only means there are things nobody has asked about yet, and most of them are one easy conversation away.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of Mom's week the family knows and which nobody has written down. The care interview asks about each part of her daily life in turn and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›